Lena Varga-Holm

Application: Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform
Halden Pay

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role at Halden Pay. Your focus on reusable frameworks rather than one-off pipelines matches my experience owning ingestion and orchestration at Lukovac Freight Hub. I bring production platform experience with Airflow, dbt, Python and SQL, alongside payments experience from Kovalent Pay, where I built reconciliation jobs matching bank settlement files against internal ledgers.

At Lukovac, I designed and built a shipment event pipeline processing around 30 million events per day with p95 latency under two minutes. I added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling so failed events could be reprocessed without data loss. I also migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into tested, documented dbt models, introduced incremental models and slim CI in GitHub Actions, and cut nightly warehouse builds from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. Alongside delivery, I participate in the platform's on-call rotation and mentor two mid-level engineers. These responsibilities connect platform design with reliable day-to-day operation and support for colleagues.

My cloud experience is on AWS, including EMR, S3 and MSK, alongside Snowflake and Redshift; I earned the AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate certification in May 2024. At Kovalent Pay, PySpark reconciliation jobs reduced finance's manual month-end work from approximately three days to four hours, with Great Expectations supporting data quality. My open-source work includes two merged pull requests to an Airflow provider package, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests. That experience is directly relevant to your emphasis on open-source tools and engineering practices that deliver a clear benefit.

I would bring Halden Pay a combination of platform ownership, measurable operational improvements and practical payments data experience. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my work on ingestion, transformation and data quality could support the shared platform your analysts, data scientists and product teams rely on.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm